suitable for democracy and interreligious dialogue in pluralist societies.[43]

In 2016, India hosted the World Sufi Forum, which convened hundreds of spiritual leaders and scholars to debate how Sufism can counter global terrorism. In terms of soft power, the meeting aimed to highlight Sufism as India's brand of moderate Islam and as a peaceful counter-narrative to radical Wahhabi and Salafi currents. Speaking at the opening ceremony, Prime Minister Modi emphasised the symbiotic ties between this faith and India's pluralist society:

> Sufism is the voice of peace, co-existence, compassion and equality; a call to universal brotherhood … and, just as India became a principal center of Islamic civilization, our nation also emerged as one of the most vibrant hubs of Sufism. … Sufism blossomed in India's openness and pluralism.[44]

Yoga as a social culture of pluralism

Yoga is a collection of spiritual, mental, and physical practices originating in ancient India, which is popular both domestically and across the world. It is recognised as a tool for soft power due to its proclivity to transcend societal barriers, which is why it has been chosen to exemplify India's *social* pluralism. Yoga does not adhere to any particular religion, belief system, or community, and Indian diplomats abroad have energetically promoted it as a distinctively Indian approach to global wellbeing.

From the beginning of his mandate, Prime Minister Modi made yoga a key element of India's new soft power strategy. During his first speech to the United Nations General Assembly, in 2014, he proposed adopting an